

OpenAI to prioritise practical adoption of AI in 2026



OpenAI will focus on “practical adoption” of AI in 2026, according to CFO Sarah Friar, aiming to turn rapid AI

advances into everyday tools for people, businesses, and governments. Despite concerns over massive data center investments and future ad revenue plans, Friar says OpenAI’s compute and revenue growth show unprecedented scale and adoption.

tinyurl.com/783e2g

Microsoft trims libraries and news access in major AI push



Microsoft is accelerating AI adoption by cutting employee access to news subscriptions and library resources as part of an AI focused learning

push. Following last year’s layoffs affecting 15,000 staff, the company has told publishers it will not renew contracts, including long running ties with Strategic News Service. CEO Satya Nadella is overseeing the shift, while Microsoft AI CEO Mustafa Suleyman predicts deeply personal AI companions will become common within five years. tinyurl.com/eoij21

Sam Altman’s problem

Apple’s Gemini pick for Siri disempowers ChatGPT

—By **Jayesh Shinde**

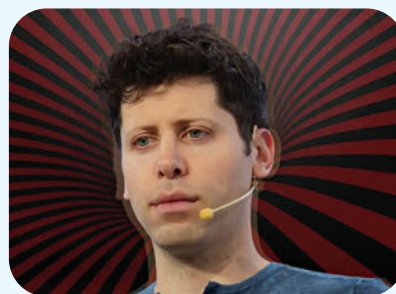
Apple didn’t just announce its new AI partner in Google and Gemini models last month, it dealt a body blow to OpenAI and Sam Altman. When Apple said its next-gen Foundation Models will be based on Google’s Gemini and cloud tech, powering future Apple Intelligence features, and the long-promised, personality-filled Siri upgrade due later in 2026, it must’ve given Altman serious pause.

Sam Altman’s fear about an ascendant Google, where Gemini starts to match and even outperform ChatGPT models, seems to be coming true faster than anyone would’ve thought. That Apple’s ecosystem would be the key battleground for this fight between OpenAI and Google must’ve been on very few bingo cards for 2026.

Because since WWDC 2024, ChatGPT has been Apple’s sanctioned external GenAI brain – where Siri could hand off tougher questions to OpenAI, but only after asking you first. Hence, the Apple-Google announcement changes that exclusive equation for Sam Altman and ChatGPT.

Make no mistake, Apple isn’t merely “also supporting” Gemini, it’s putting Gemini under the floorboards. In the joint language of the two companies, it leaves no doubt whatsoever that Apple’s next-gen foundation models are built on Google’s Gemini plus cloud infra.

For OpenAI, the sting is painful. It isn’t just Sam Altman’s pride that took a hit, but also ChatGPT’s future distribu-



tion – the boring but crucial part of tech that decides who wins after the demos stop dazzling. On that front, Siri sits on a huge scale across the globe. Apple says it now has more than two billion active devices, which means the assistant you open by accident is the assistant you end up trusting in the future.

In hindsight, Google understood this long ago, of course, which is why the

Gemini 3 launch in November 2025 felt less like a model release and more like an invasion plan – Gemini everywhere, immediately, across consumer apps and enterprise pipes.

We can now guess that Sam Altman, by most accounts, saw this Google Gemini wave coming. In December, reports described an internal “code red” at OpenAI, where he asked everyone to pause everything else, and devote energies towards making ChatGPT faster, sturdier, more personal, and ship like your lunch depends on it.

OpenAI even answered with a sprint, as the GPT-5.2 launch was framed as part of that “code red” push to counter Gemini 3. But Apple’s move is a reminder that cutting edge innovation can still be insufficient. You can build the best brain in the room but still sit in dark if someone else controls the light switch.

Just to be clear, Apple isn’t exiling ChatGPT. The earlier integration remains, largely as an opt-in escalation path for complex requests – in short, useful but no longer central. The centre of gravity shifts to Gemini, and gravity is what creates habits. For Sam Altman, the headache is that this isn’t a one-off product skirmish. tinyurl.com/hdg781